

Durably Green & Social Claims Risk Scan - Methodology

Version: v43 - restored red flags, clearer claim wording, report downloads and methodology access.

This document explains the logic used by the Durably Green & Social Claims Risk Scan. The scan is an indicative first-pass assessment. It is not legal advice, does not establish a violation of law, and does not make a definitive greenwashing or social-washing finding.

1. Scope of the scan

The tool reviews either a website/page set or one uploaded internal document. Website and document scans are separate: results are not combined. It focuses on claim risk, not broad ESG performance. It identifies wording that may be too broad, generic, absolute, comparative, future-oriented, label/icon-based, insufficiently evidenced, or potentially contradicted by relevant public-source context.

2. Core scoring dimensions

Dimension	What is assessed
Claim wording	Whether detected words or sentences imply environmental or social performance, superiority, neutrality, responsibility, product/supplier assurance, or stakeholder benefits.
Substantiation gap	Whether scope, KPIs, methodology, baseline, limitations, verification, traceability, grievance/remedy or corrective-action evidence appears to be missing.
External context	Whether external public-source signals appear relevant and potentially contradictory. Company-owned reports/policies are not treated as external signals.
Audience and sector	Whether the claim appears consumer-facing, investor/reporting-focused or internal; and whether sector exposure increases sensitivity.

3. Green-claim lens

Green claims are assessed using an EmpCo / Directive (EU) 2024/825 lens for consumer-facing environmental claims. High-priority modules include generic environmental claims, climate-neutrality and offsetting claims, sustainability labels and badges, future environmental-performance claims, comparative environmental claims, circularity/recyclability/durability claims, absolute/purity wording, and legal requirements presented as green benefits.

4. Social-claim lens

Social claims are assessed using claim wording, evidence gap, sector sensitivity and external contradictory-context signals. The lens covers human rights, labour rights, forced labour, child labour, modern slavery, supplier responsibility, traceability, responsible sourcing, diversity and inclusion, worker welfare, customer welfare, accessibility, affordability, and community-impact claims.

5. Forced Labour Regulation lens

For product, supplier, import/export, traceability, forced-labour or modern-slavery wording, the scan applies a specific Regulation (EU) 2024/3015 risk lens. Claims should not imply product or supply-chain assurance unless supported by robust risk assessment, supplier/product traceability, preventive actions, remediation, disengagement criteria and withdrawal/customs response readiness.

6. Red-flag interpretation

Red flags are grouped into regulatory red flags, claim wording and evidence gaps, external public-source signals, and sector/context sensitivity. They are intended to help legal, compliance, sustainability and marketing teams prioritise manual review. A red flag is a review signal, not a finding of non-compliance.

7. Report outputs

The company report provides an executive summary, global/green/social risk scores, score drivers, detected claim wording with problematic trigger terms highlighted, red flags, pre-publication review, external signals, recommended

actions, methodology and a text report. The claim register CSV can be used as a working file for claim governance.

8. Limitations

Automated crawling may miss pages blocked by websites, content loaded dynamically, content behind login walls, images, videos, PDFs or embedded files. PDF extraction is best-effort. Search results are snippets and must be manually verified. The scan should be treated as an early warning and governance support tool, not as legal advice or formal assurance.

Examples of higher-risk wording include: green, eco, sustainable, natural, climate neutral, carbon neutral, net zero product, offset, better for the planet, greener than, lower emissions, recyclable, biodegradable, circular, certified, green choice, ethical, fair, responsible sourcing, traceable, forced labour free, all suppliers, 100% sustainable and zero impact.